

Beta-3 Agonists (for Overactive Bladder)

Patient Information · A newer bladder pill with fewer dry-mouth effects

WARWIKI

Beta-3 agonists are a newer group of pills for **overactive bladder**: sudden urges, frequent trips and urge leaks. They relax the bladder so it can hold more. They cause **much less dry mouth and constipation** than the older anticholinergic pills. The two in use are **mirabegron (Myrbetriq)** and **vibegron (Gemtesa)**.

How It Works

They switch on **beta-3 receptors** in the bladder wall. This **relaxes the bladder muscle** as it fills. A calmer bladder means fewer sudden urges and fewer trips. They work in a different way from anticholinergics, and about as well.

What to Expect

- Taken **once a day**. The benefit builds over **about 4–8 weeks**.
- Most people have few side effects and little or no dry mouth.
- Often a good first choice for **older adults**, or for anyone who had side effects from anticholinergics.
- Vibegron is also approved for men who take medicine for an enlarged prostate.
- For stubborn symptoms, it can be combined with an anticholinergic.

Learn the Terms

Overactive bladder (OAB)

Urgency and frequent urination from the bladder squeezing too soon.

Beta-3 agonist

A pill that relaxes the bladder through beta-3 receptors.

Mirabegron and vibegron

The two medicines in this group.

Anticholinergic

The older group of OAB pills, with more dry mouth and memory concerns.

Blood pressure

Mirabegron can raise it a little, so it is checked.

Why choose this over the older pills? Beta-3 agonists work about as well as anticholinergics, with **much less dry mouth and constipation**. They do not add to the “anticholinergic” load linked to memory problems, which is why many teams prefer them for older adults. Studies of long-term memory effects disagree, so it is not yet known whether they are safer for memory over many years. The main thing to watch is blood pressure with mirabegron.

How to Take It

- Take it **once a day** as directed. Give it several weeks to work.
- Keep up bladder training and pelvic floor exercises for the best result.
- Keep your follow-up visits so your team can check the effect and your blood pressure.

Important Safety

- **Mirabegron can raise blood pressure.** It is not used if your blood pressure is very high and not controlled. Vibegron has little effect on blood pressure.
- Tell your team about all your medicines, especially **digoxin** or heart rhythm medicines. Some levels may need checking.
- Tell your team if you have **kidney or liver disease**, or trouble emptying your bladder.

Common Side Effects

- Usually mild: headache, stuffy nose
- Urine infection
- A rise in blood pressure (mainly mirabegron)

Call the office that is treating you if you have:

- Blood pressure much higher than usual, or a bad headache
- A weak stream, or you feel you are not emptying

Go to an emergency department if:

- Your face, lips, tongue or throat swell, or you have trouble breathing
- You cannot urinate for several hours and your bladder feels full or painful
- You cannot reach the office and are worried

Three Things to Remember

1. Beta-3 agonists relax the bladder, with far less dry mouth than the older pills.
2. They are often a good fit for older adults. Give them several weeks.
3. Mirabegron can raise blood pressure, so keep your check-ups.